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TAB 33



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-049-25/26, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 3/10/2026**In Control:** Board of Education

Ms. Gonez - Learning Begins at Birth: Growing LAUSD Early Learning Programs (Res-049-25/26) (For Action April 21, 2026)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District (LAUSD) is committed to serving the needs of its youngest learners and strengthening engagement with families through high quality, accessible, early education programs for children ages 0-4 and as of the 2025-2026 school year LAUSD serves a total of 14,228 students in Transitional Kindergarten and 10,671 children in our Early Education Centers, California State Pre-School Program and Infant Centers;

Whereas, LAUSD has taken significant steps to expand access to early childhood education for young learners, including increasing enrollment in early education centers for 2 to 4 year olds and making changes such as removing potty training requirements and opening enrollment beyond traditional income limits, resulting in a more inclusive, accessible preschool system for families in Los Angeles ([LAist, May 2025](https://laist.com/news/education/early-childhood-education-pre-k/laUSD-preschool-enrollment-up-policy-change-toilet-training-income)) <<https://laist.com/news/education/early-childhood-education-pre-k/laUSD-preschool-enrollment-up-policy-change-toilet-training-income>>;

Whereas, Early education programs have been shown to improve school readiness and long term academic success for all children, particularly those from historically underserved communities, including low-income families, multilingual learners, and children with disabilities, and a high-quality preschool experience has been linked to lasting advantages such as higher educational attainment including graduation rates, significant reductions in special education placement as well as better long-term health outcomes, and lower crime rates ([McCoy et al. 2017](https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/30147124/)) <<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/30147124/>>;

Whereas, Early education is frequently a family's first interaction with LAUSD, introducing families to District schools, serving as powerful tools for building trust, strengthening enrollment pipelines, promoting school readiness, and supporting long-term community engagement with District schools;

Whereas, Even as options for four-years-olds have increased (such as through universal transitional kindergarten) and capacity to serve three-year-olds has grown, access to infant and toddler programs remain limited in many parts of Los Angeles, creating barriers for working families, particularly those who rely on affordable care;

Whereas, LAUSD maintains an inventory of facilities that could potentially host additional infant centers and early childhood education programs, yet greater coordination is needed to prioritize expansion in communities with the highest need;

Whereas, Partnerships with early childcare providers help meet our family's unique needs, expand access, and create enrollment pipelines into LAUSD schools, these partnerships would benefit from clear protocols and alignment with District priorities;

Whereas, Dual language early education programs promote bilingualism, biliteracy, academic achievement, and cultural affirmation, yet access remains limited and there is no clear picture of the community demand for programs;

Whereas, The expansion of early learning sites including infant centers and dual immersion programs in high need communities play a critical role in closing literacy and numeracy gaps, strengthening school readiness and improving long term academic outcomes for students; and

Whereas, A strategic and coordinated approach to our early education program expansion is necessary to ensure that equity focused program growth simultaneously advances both student success and District enrollment goals; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District recognizes the essential role of early childhood education to the wellbeing of our children, families and communities, and commits to leveraging its programs and partnerships to expand access to affordable, high-quality early learning opportunities in Los Angeles;

Resolved further, That the Los Angeles Unified School District shall develop a plan to increase access to early education programs by opening new infant centers and early education centers, increasing dual immersion programs and exploring partnerships with external early education providers; be it further

Resolved further, That the Early Education Expansion plan shall include recommendations for:

- Reopening of shuttered early education centers and/or opening of new centers on elementary campuses, based on unmet community needs and prioritizing access for low-income families;
- Expanding infant center programs for children age 0-2, to ensure each board district has an open center by 2028;
- Dual language program expansion at Early Education Centers and in transitional kindergarten (TK) at elementary schools, such that every elementary school dual-language program is connected to a feeder preschool dual-language program, while considering teacher recruitment, training, credentialing and strategies for program sustainability and expansion.

Resolved further, That for each item above, the plan shall consider expected demand and communities without an existing program, current use of sites, required facilities upgrades, operational costs, available funding sources, staffing, and strategic opportunities to co-locate with adult school campuses that provide workforce training pathways for adult students, incorporating these considerations into the recommendations for the Board's consideration;

Resolved further, That the District shall create an inventory of community-based providers and include in the plan strategies for enhanced partnerships with existing external providers, aligned with LAUSD early education goals. Such strategies shall include shared professional development opportunities, increased communication, articulation agreements, and an analysis of potential partnerships with family home providers to support early education students during intersession and before/after-school and whether underutilized district spaces could be utilized by community-based organizations to provide expanded early education opportunities and services for current and future LAUSD families; and, be it finally,

Resolved, That the District will report back to the Board within 120 days with the Early Education Expansion Plan and implementation framework that includes the above considerations, prioritized sites, timelines, and actionable steps to begin expansion of District programs and potential partnerships with community-based providers.